

Citizenship

Plutarch
Current Events
Community Read Alouds





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Plutarch: Beginner Track, Current Events: Grades 5-8, Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12

About Plutarch: Beginner Track

This set of lesson plans eases students into Plutarch lessons with one of his most engaging and accessible lives so that students don't miss this important book that Mason valued so highly.

About Current Events: Grades 5-8

Students are exposed to current events by reading from a variety of sources and having age-appropriate conversations with teachers. Topics such as scientific discoveries, the arts, and human interest stories are generally suitable.

About Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12

This is meant to be a read-aloud for all ages to enjoy together in the afternoon at least 1 time a week. We encourage you to choose a book that is specific to your region. However, we will offer some suggestions in the Grades 1-3 Literature lessons and Grades 4+ Citizenship lessons. The suggested book titles will be available June 1st in the lesson plans.



Placement & Combining Tips

Plutarch: Beginner Track

Older students beginning Plutarch for the first time may wish to start with this level as a replacement for other Plutarch lessons.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
5+	Plutarch: Beginner Track 1 time/week 30 min	The Plutarch Project Primer: Publicola (Revised)
5-8	Current Events: Grades 5-8 1+ time/week 15 min	
1-12	Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12 1+ time/week 20 min+	

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 5				
Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12	Current Events: Grades 5-8			Plutarch: Beginner Track



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Citizenship: Grade 5

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Citizenship: Grade 5

Plutarch: Beginner Track



The Plutarch Project Primer: Publicola (Revised)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Citizenship: Grade 5

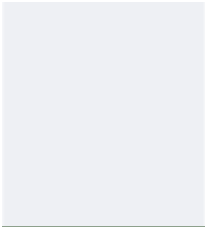
- ∞ [Community Read Alouds](#)
- ∞ [Setting Up a Citizenship Notebook](#)
- ∞ [Video: How to Teach Plutarch \(see Citizenship: Section 7\)](#)

Current Events: Grades 5-8

- ∞ [The Pour Over | Subscribe](#)
- ∞ [The World and Everything In It](#)
- ∞ [World Watch \(Paid Subscription Required\)](#)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



- 
- ∞ [The Sift](#)
 - ∞ [BBC](#)
 - ∞ [Teaching Kids News \(CA\)](#)
 - ∞ [1Jour1Actu \(in French\)](#)
-

Citizenship: Grade 5

How To Teach



Prepare

Plutarch: Teachers will find it helpful to preread the entire Life first, and then preread the day's passage before each lesson. Mark any passages that should be omitted due to content. (In Anne White's Plutarch Project books, the recommended source for this course, objectionable content has already been omitted.)

Current Events: Preview the news source for suitability.

Most other citizenship topics don't require additional prep.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources, show students how to scan the headlines to get an overview first and then choose a story to read.

For Plutarch or other books: Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story as relevant. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves* and *Plutarch*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, *Book of Centuries*, and/or *Commonplace book*.



Narrate

Have the students narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions to help students discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Have students record important ideas in their Citizenship Notebooks.

Citizenship: Grade 5

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)

QR

Term 1

WEEK 1

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 1

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: You may want to read a retelling so you can be familiar with the story. This is not to be read to the students.

- ∞ Link: Retelling of Publicola from Our Young Folks' Plutarch
- Read about Publicola and the intro material, p.11-14
- Pre-read the lesson so you are comfortable reading aloud.

→ INTRO

1. Plutarch was born in Greece a few years after the death of Christ in the year 45 AD and died around 120 AD. He said that his purpose was to write lives, not histories. A life was a portrait of a man's inner self, whereas a history was an account of men's actions and fortunes without focusing on what the people were like who produced them. Plutarch's Lives is a book of patterns, models on which men may mold themselves, and be inspired to do so. Greatness is Plutarch's theme, not great fortune—he loves to depict a hero in adversity. (From Introduction to Plutarch by Edith Hamilton, p.xv-xvii.)
2. We are reading about a Roman man named Publicola who lived around 550 BC. His actual name was Publius Valerius, but his nickname became Publicola, which means a man of the people or loved by the people. Listen for the actions that caused him to be given that nickname. In the book, he will be referred to as Valerius.
3. When this account begins, Rome is ruled by King Tarquin. But when his son's outrageous behavior caused a public scandal, the king was removed from the throne.
4. Let's look at the characters. (See right-hand column. You may want to write their names on a whiteboard.)
5. We will read about how the Romans went from a monarchy (king) to a republic with consuls as the main officials of the government.

→ LOCATE

- ∞ Map Link: Map of the Regions of Italy
- At this time, there was no unified country called Italy. It was made up of many city-states or regions. Find the region of Rome and the Sabini. What do you think the people from those areas are called? (Romans and Sabines) These two areas had been at war with each other.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson 1, p.17-18 "Such was Solon" - "consul with Brutus."

→ DISCUSS

Why do you think Valerius thought he would become the consul with Brutus?

★ TEACHER TIP

You may want to write the definitions of the vocabulary words in pencil next to the words or in the margin so you can say the definition right after you read the word in the text. You may also want to write a few of the words on a whiteboard with a definition or synonym.

CHARACTERS

Valerius aka Publicola

Tarquin-last king of Rome

Brutus-joined with Valerius to head up revolt against the king, considered founder of Roman Republic

DEFINITIONS

republic- A form of government in which the people elect, or choose, their leaders

consul-the chief civil and military official of the Roman Republic. Two were elected yearly and they presided over meetings of the senate and assemblies of the whole people and put into effect the decrees they enacted. In war they took command of the army.

WEEK 1

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 1

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

CHARACTERS

Tarquinius Collatinus-Lucretia's husband

DEFINITIONS

solicitations-to urge something, such as one's cause strongly (p.18)

★ TEACHER TIP

Why is Plutarch relevant today and why is it included as part of Citizenship? These links can help answer those questions. You may wish to share pieces of what you

WEEK 2

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 2

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Review vocabulary and pre-read the lesson.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

What might be hard for people to change from a monarchy to a republic, from a king to a government where people elect their leaders? We read last time that Valerius thought that he might become one of the consuls. Let's find out what happens. (Set up the scene by reviewing

Term 1

characters and going over vocabulary words. See Teacher's Notes.)
You may want to write the names on a whiteboard.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson 1 p.18-19 "Howbeit this" - "sincerity of his oath."

→ DISCUSS

- How does Valerius show his loyalty to the republic and not the former king, even though he wasn't chosen as consul?
- What does that say about his character?

learn with your students.

∞ **Article:** From Cicero to Trump, they're all in Plutarch's Lives

∞ **Article:** Teaching Plutarch in the Age of Hollywood

WEEK 2

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 2

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 3

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 3

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and pre-read the lesson. You may want to write names and select vocab words on a whiteboard.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

Read aloud the intro in the book. Why might people be persuaded to help their king or let him come back? (Set up scene by reviewing any characters and explaining a couple of vocabulary words.)

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson 2, p.21-22 "For there came" - "out after them."

→ DISCUSS

Why do you think Valerius did not want the ambassadors to talk to the people of Rome?

CHARACTERS

Collatinus- In this section, he is only referred to by this name. He is Tarquinius Collatinus, the co-consul and husband of Lucretia.

DEFINITIONS

ambassador- representative or messenger (p.21)

subsidies-gift of money (p.22)

suffer- to allow (p.22)

tyranny/tyrants-government in which absolute power is found in a single ruler (p.22)

WEEK 3

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 3

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

Term 1

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 4

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 4

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Review vocabulary and pre-read the lesson. You may want to write names and select vocab words on a whiteboard.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

We will be introduced to two families that were influential in Rome—the Aquillians and Vitellians. (Write these names on a whiteboard.) The ambassadors of King Tarquin were trying to win them over. The Vitellians were related to Brutus and tried to win over Brutus' sons. We will read what will happen.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Lesson 2 p.22-23 "The questions, however" - "at the consultation."

- Why were Brutus' sons persuaded to kill the consuls?

CHARACTERS

Collatinus- Tarquinius Collatinus, the co-consul and husband of Lucretia.

Vindicius- a slave who overhears an important conversation

DEFINITIONS

entrails-internal parts (p.23)

★ TEACHER TIP

Plutarch's writing can be confusing at times because of his overuse of pronouns. Sometimes it gets confusing to determine what antecedent the pronoun refers to. It might be helpful in those places to replace the pronouns with the actual nouns.

WEEK 4

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 4

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 5

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 5

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and pre-read the lesson. You may want to write names and select vocab words on a whiteboard.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

Do you remember who overheard the plot to kill the consuls? (The slave Vindicius). What will he do with that information? We will read about what he decides to do and what happens to the conspirators.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Lesson 3 p.26 "Upon their departure" - "into the Forum."

- Why did Vindicius decide to tell Valerius first?

CHARACTERS

Vindicius-slave
Marcus Valerius- Valerius's brother

DEFINITIONS

inducement- a motive or consideration that leads one to action (p.26)

WEEK 5

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 5

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make

Term 1

sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 6

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 6

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Review vocabulary and pre-read the lesson. You may want to write names and select vocab words on a whiteboard.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

1. At the end of this section, Plutarch mentions Romulus, who was considered the founder of Rome. Let's watch this video that tells about the legend of the twin boys, Romulus and Remus.
∞ Video Link: The Legend of the Founding of Rome
2. Set up the scene by explaining any new characters or a couple of vocabulary words. You may want to write the names on a whiteboard.
3. Review any vocabulary in the right-hand column.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Lesson 3 p.26-27 "There the consuls" - "foundation of the city."

- Why do you think Plutarch said that "Brutus did a greater work in the establishment of the government than Romulus did in the foundation of the city"?

CHARACTERS

Titus & Tiberius-Brutus's sons

DEFINITIONS

lictors-the bodyguards of the consuls, made up of twelve men. Each lictor carried a bundle of sticks (rods) that also contained an axe (p.27)

countenance- expression (p.27)

WEEK 6

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 6

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 7

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 7

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and pre-read the lesson. You may want to write names and select vocab words on a whiteboard.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

Read aloud the first paragraph of the introduction from the book. (Set up scene by reviewing the characters or a couple of vocabulary words. You may want to write the names on a whiteboard.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

CHARACTERS

Vindicius-slave

Brutus-co-consul

Collatinus-co-consul

DEFINITIONS

harboured-to take shelter or hide (p.30)

Term 1

Lesson 4 p.29-30 "Upon Brutus's departure" - "stricken off."

- Why did Valerius care about the slave over the Aquillians? What does that say about his character?

WEEK 7

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 7

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 8

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 8

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Review vocabulary and pre-read the lesson. You may want to write names and select vocab words on a whiteboard.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

Set up the scene by reviewing characters or vocabulary words. You may want to write the names on a whiteboard.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Lesson 4 p.30-31 "Now the consul" - "Holy Island in Rome."

- How did Valerius's zeal for Rome's republic finally pay off?

CHARACTERS

Collantinus-co-consul

Vindicius-slave became a freedman

Valerius-becomes co-consul

DEFINITIONS

zeal- eagerness and passionate interest in pursuit of something (p.30)

WEEK 8

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 8

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

Term 1

WEEK 9

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 9

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and pre-read the lesson. You may want to write names and select vocab words on a whiteboard.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

Read the intro in the book aloud. (Set up scene by explaining a couple of vocabulary words. You may want to write the names on a whiteboard.)

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of Regions of Italy

As mentioned before, there were many different people groups that made up Italy at this time. We will read about the Tuscans. They lived in a part of the region that is labeled "Etrurians." Find that on the map.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Lesson 5 p.33-34 "Tarquinius then being" - "it did afterwards."

- What do you think that "divine announcement" could have been? (See note in book on p.34)

→ VIEW

Look at this picture that depicts a Roman triumph. A Roman Triumph was a spectacular celebration parade held in the ancient city of Rome for a military commander who had won an important victory on the battlefield. Plutarch says that this victory over the Tuscans marked the first Roman Triumph.

∞ Image Link: Image of a Roman Triumph

DEFINITIONS

enmity- mutual hatred or ill will (p.33)

adversaries-enemies or opponents (p.33)

ILLUSTRATE- Draw a picture of the Roman Triumph using watercolors or pastels.

WEEK 9

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 9

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 10

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 10

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and pre-read the lesson. You may want to write names and select vocab words on a whiteboard.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

Now that Brutus has died, Valerius is the only consul until a new one is elected. The people thought that Valerius was acting too much like a king in various ways. Let's read to find out how Valerius responds to these criticisms.

→ READ, NARRATE,

Lesson 6 p.36-37 "The people applauded" - "of Vica Pota."

→ NARRATE

This is a good section to act out the narration

→ DISCUSS

Term 1

It says that the people "expressed their wonder and their respect for Valerius's magnanimity." Magnanimity means generosity of spirit. To be magnanimous is to be noble and to have a greatness of mind and heart. This is how good leaders should be characterized. Charlotte Mason would say that good citizens should be magnanimous people. How did Valerius show magnanimity in this reading?

WEEK 10 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 10

Tracker

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 11 30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 11

 Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Review vocabulary and pre-read the lesson.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

While Valerius was waiting for another consul to be elected, he used his authority to make some changes to the government and laws.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Lesson 6 p.37-38 "Now because" - "and porci, hogs."

- How did Publicola show that he was a leader who cared about the people and not his own power?

WEEK 11 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 11

Tracker

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.



Term 1

WEEK 12 **30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 12**
→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

WEEK 12 **15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 12**
Tracker

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ **INTRO**

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ **LOCATE**

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ **NOTEBOOK**

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

Term 2

WEEK 1

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 13

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and pre-read the lesson. You may want to write names and select vocab words on a whiteboard.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

Read the introduction in the book aloud. Review characters and definitions in the right-hand column.

→ VIEW

Look at this marble panel that shows 6 fasces.

∞ Image Link: Marble depicting six fasces

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of Regions of Italy

We are reading about the Tuscans again. Find the region that is labeled "Etrurians" on the map.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Lesson 7 p.40-42 Parts One & Two

CHARACTERS

Lucretius-father of Lucretia (the woman who killed herself in the first reading), who becomes a consul for a very short period of time

Marcus Horatius-becomes co-consul with Publicola

DEFINITIONS

fasces-originally it was the rod and axe that were carried by the lictors (bodyguards), but later the axe was removed, and it became symbolic to show power and authority (p.41)

WEEK 1

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 13

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

• What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 2

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 14

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and pre-read the lesson. You may want to write names and select vocab words on a whiteboard.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

Read aloud the first paragraph of the introduction. (Review the character and explain the vocabulary word. You may want to write these on a whiteboard.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Lesson 8 p.44-45 "The building of" - "showed no discomposure."

• Why do you think the noblemen and senators were jealous of Publicola?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Drawing of the Temple of Jupiter

CHARACTERS

Horatius-co-consul with Publicola

DEFINITIONS

discomposure-the state or feeling of being disturbed or agitated (p.45)

WEEK 2

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 14

Tracker

□ □ □ □ □

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

Term 2

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 3

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 15

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

→ NOTE

This is an optional lesson since it is not about Publicola.

PREP: Pre-read the lesson.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

This section tells about how the Temple of Jupiter was built and rebuilt over the years. It is not important to remember all the names mentioned.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Lesson 8 p.45-46 "The same fortune" - "twelve thousand talents."

→ VIEW

Read this article together that tells about the different temples and shows coins from the time period.

∞ Article Link: Coins: The Temple Through Time

WEEK 3

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 15

Tracker

□ □ □ □ □

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 4

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 16

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and pre-read the lesson.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

Tarquin has not given up yet. He gets help from a prince in Italy named Lars Porsena. We will see what happens when they oppose the Romans. (Set up the lesson by reviewing the names and putting them on the whiteboard.)

CHARACTERS

Tarquin-last king of Rome

Lars Porsena-ruler of Clusium in Etruria

Titus Lucretius-new co-consul with Publicola

Horatius Cocles-helped defend the Romans

Term 2

→ LOCATE

We have looked at the region of Etruria in other lessons. Now let's look closer and find the city of Clusium. That is the Etruscan name for it. The Roman name is Clusium, and a powerful prince of Italy lived there who wanted to help Tarquin regain his power.

∞ Map Link: Map of Ancient Etruria

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Lesson 9 Part 1 p.48-49

→ VIEW

There is a famous poem called Horatius at the Bridge that depicts this story. It is quite long, but this PDF has a shortened version of it.

∞ PDF Link: Horatius at the Bridge (abridged)

WEEK 4

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 16

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

• What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 5

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 17

□ Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Review vocabulary and pre-read the lesson. You may want to write names and select vocab words on a whiteboard.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

Read aloud the second paragraph of the introduction in the book. Review the characters and explain the vocabulary word. You may want to write the names on a whiteboard.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Lesson 9 Part 2 p.49-50

• Why was Porsena so impressed by Mucius?

CHARACTERS

Mucius-Roman soldier

Porsena-ruler of Clusium, who is on Tarquin's side.

DEFINITIONS

incursions- entering into (p.49)

WEEK 5

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 17

Tracker

□ □ □ □ □

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

• What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

Term 2

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 6

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 18

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and pre-read the lesson. You may want to write names and select vocab words on a whiteboard.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

Read the introduction aloud. Set up the scene by reviewing characters. You may want to write the names on a whiteboard.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Lesson 10 p.52-53 "But Publicola" - "back to Porsena."

- What does this incident tell us about Publicola's character?

CHARACTERS

King Porsena-ruler of Clusium

Valeria-Publicola's daughter

Cloelia-daughter of a Roman nobleman

WEEK 6

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 18

Tracker

□ □ □ □ □

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 7

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 19

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Review vocabulary and pre-read the lesson. You may want to write names on a whiteboard.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

We read last time that Publicola sent the girls back. Do you think they will stay put or try going back to Rome again? (Set up the scene by reviewing characters and putting their names on the whiteboard.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Lesson 10 p.53-54 "But Tarquin's men" - "antique workmanship."

CHARACTERS

King Porsena-ruler of Clusium

Valerius-daughter of Publicola

Aruns-Porsena's son

WEEK 7

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 19

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

Term 2

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 8

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 20

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and pre-read the lesson. You may want to write names and select vocab words on a whiteboard.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

We are going to read about two different times when the Sabines attacked Rome. Part One is when Publicola is not consul. Part Two is when Publicola becomes consul for the fourth time. (Review the characters and explain vocabulary words. You may want to write the names on a whiteboard.)

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of the Regions of Italy

Find the region of Sabini. The people from there are called Sabines. They were briefly mentioned in the first lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Note: Read Part 1 and then narrate. Then begin Part 2 p.56 "Afterwards, the Sabines" - "delayed the war."

CHARACTERS

Marcus Valerius-Publicola's brother who becomes a consul

Postumius Tubertus-co-consul with Marcus

Appius Clausus-man from Sabini who spoke against the war with Rome

DEFINITIONS

eloquence- the art or power of speaking or writing in a forceful and convincing way (p.56)

WEEK 8

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 20

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 9

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 21

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Review vocabulary and pre-read the lesson.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

What was different about the Appius Clausus compared to the other Sabines? The Sabines were not happy with him. We will read how Publicola handled this situation. (Review the characters. You may want to write the names on a whiteboard.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Lesson 11 Part 2 p.57 "Publicola, also for" - "none in Rome."

- Why was that a wise decision by Publicola to invite Appius Clausus and others to Rome?

CHARACTERS

Appius Clausus-man from Sabini who spoke against the war with Rome

Term 2

WEEK 9

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 21

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 10

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 22

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and pre-read the lesson. You may want to write names and select vocab words on a whiteboard.

→ RECAP

What did we read last time?

→ INTRO

Do you think the Sabines are happy that Clausus and 5000 other families moved to Rome? (Read aloud the introduction from the book. Review the characters and vocabulary words. You may want to write the names on a whiteboard.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Lesson 12 Part 1 and 2 p.59-61

- Explain the strategies Rome used to defeat the Sabines.

CHARACTERS

Clausus-the man from Sabine who moved to Rome

Postumius Balbus-Publicola's son-in-law

Lucretius-Roman general

DEFINITIONS

ambuscade/ambush-a setup in which hidden attackers lie in wait (p.59)

WEEK 10

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 22

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 11

30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 23

Materials: The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

Term 2

WEEK 11 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 23

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 12 30m Plutarch: Beginner Track - Lesson 24

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

The Plutarch Primer: Publicola

WEEK 12 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 24

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.



Term 3

WEEK 1 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 25 Tracker News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source → INTRO Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	
WEEK 2 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 26 Tracker News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source → INTRO Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	
WEEK 3 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 27 Tracker News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source → INTRO Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	



Term 3	
WEEK 4 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 28 Tracker News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source → INTRO Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	
WEEK 5 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 29 Tracker News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source → INTRO Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	
WEEK 6 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 30 Tracker News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source → INTRO Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	



Term 3	
WEEK 7 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 31 Tracker News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source → INTRO Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	
WEEK 8 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 32 Tracker News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source → INTRO Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	
WEEK 9 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 33 Tracker News source of your choice PREP: Preview news source → INTRO Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news). → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS News story • What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible? → LOCATE Look at a map and find where the events occurred → NOTEBOOK Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.	

Term 3

WEEK 10 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 34

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 11 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 35

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 12 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 36

Tracker

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News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

Citizenship: Grade 5

Examination

Term 1

Plutarch: Beginner Track

- The Plutarch Primer: Publicola: How did Publicola live up to his name "loved by the people"?

Current Events: Grades 5-8

- Tell the story of one of the news events of this term.

Term 2

Plutarch: Beginner Track

- The Plutarch Primer: Publicola: Pick one of the events to show how Publicola was a wise leader:

1. The situation with Porsena, Tarquin, and the Roman girls sent as hostages.
2. The situation with the Sabine man, Clausus, who was disliked by his fellow citizens for opposing war.

Current Events: Grades 5-8

- Tell the story of one of the news events of this term.

Term 3

Current Events: Grades 5-8

- Tell the story of one of the news events of this term.